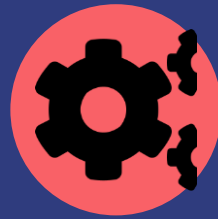


DECENT COACHING CLASSES

GRAMMAR SESSION 5 • 7th AUGUST



~~Letters~~
a, an, ^xthe
Honour

Modals, Determiners, Articles & Non-Finite Verbs

a, an, the • can, could, must, should • infinitives, gerunds & participles



BEFORE WE BEGIN

Quick Recap — Sessions 1 to 4

SESSION 1 • 3rd Aug

Parts of Speech, Subject-Verb Agreement, Question Tags & Prepositions

SESSION 2 • 4th Aug

Tenses — Simple, Continuous, Perfect, Perfect Continuous

SESSION 3 • 5th Aug

Active & Passive Voice

SESSION 4 • 6th Aug

Reported Speech — Direct & Indirect Speech

Today we shift gears — from sentence structure & reporting to the small words that carry big grammatical weight: modals, determiners, articles, and non-finite verbs!



What We Will Cover Today

A

Modal Verbs — Can, Could, May, Might, Must, Should, Will, Would, Shall, Ought to

B

Determiners — Some, Any, Each, Every, Few, Little

C

Articles — A, An & The (in full detail)

D

Non-Finite Verbs — Infinitives, Gerunds & Participles

E

Master Table — Complete Reference for All 4 Topics

F

PYQs from 8th SB, 8th CBSE, 9th CBSE & 10th SB



What is a Modal Verb?

A modal verb is a type of auxiliary (helping) verb that is used to indicate modality — that is, likelihood, ability, permission, possibility, or obligation.

ought to

The 10 Modal Verbs

Can • Could • May • Might
Must • Should • Will • Would
Shall • Ought to

Structure

Subject	<u>Modal Verb</u>	<u>Main Verb</u>	<u>Complement</u>
I / We / They / You / He / She / It	must, can, should, may, will	go, drink, eat, do ...	to sleep, some water, some food, some exercise ...

💡 JUST FOR FUN

Golden Rule: always use the BASIC form (infinitive) of the main verb after a modal — never "he can's swim" or "she musted go"!

can



3 Golden Rules of Modal Verbs

he likes to go

1

No "-s" for 3rd Person

Modal verbs do NOT add -s or -es to the third person singular.

He can swim. (NOT: He cans swim.)

2

No Auxiliary Needed

Modals don't need extra auxiliaries to form negatives or questions — just add does or invert.

She should stay. → She shouldn't stay. → Why should she stay?

3

No Infinitive / -ing Form

Modal verbs don't have infinitives or -ing forms of their own.

canning X to might X (these forms simply don't exist)



Can & Could — Uses & Examples

CAN

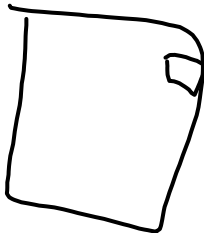
Ability / Possibility: They can control their own work.

Impossibility (can't): We can't fix it.

Asking Permission: Can I bring here?

Request: Can you help me?

May



COULD

Permission: Could I borrow your dictionary?

Request: Could you say it again please?

Possibility: I think we could meet next week.

Ability (past): I could swim well as a child.



May & Might — Uses & Examples



MAY

Permission: *May I have another cup of coffee?*

Possibility: *I may finish my homework.*

Formal Wish: *May you both live a long and happy life.*

Polite Offer: *May I take your coat?*

MIGHT

Possibility (weaker than may): *We'd better phone tomorrow — they might be eating dinner now.*

Polite Suggestion: *You might try calling her office instead.*

Past Possibility: *He might have missed the bus.*

valet 20



Must & Should — Uses & Examples

MUST X

Obligation / Necessity: You must submit the assignment today.

Strong Logical Conclusion: She must be tired after that journey.

100%

SHOULD

Saying What's Right/Correct: We should solve this problem.

Advice: She should finish it next week.

Polite X



Shall & Will — Uses & Examples

SHALL

Offer: Shall I help you with your luggage?

Suggestion: Shall we say 2.30 then?

Permission: Shall I sit or will you?

Polite

WILL

Decision: I ~~will try to fix it~~ *I'll try some way to fix it*

Offer: I'll do that for you if you like.

Promise: I'll come back on Monday.



Would & Ought to — Uses & Examples

1-2



WOULD

Permission: Would you mind if I brought a friend with me?

Request: Would you mind waiting a moment?

Invitation: Would you like to play basketball this Friday?

Past Habit: Every summer, we would visit our grandparents.

OUGHT TO

Duty / Moral Obligation: You ought to respect your elders.

Advice (similar to should): He ought to see a doctor about that cough.

Expectation: The results ought to be out by Friday.



What is a Determiner?

A determiner is a word (or group of words) that specifies, identifies, or quantifies the noun or noun phrase that follows it. There are about 50 different determiners in the English language.

1 2 3

Articles

a, an, the

Demonstrative Adjectives

this, that, these, those

Possessive Adjectives

my, your, our, their, his, her, its

Quantifiers

few, a few, much, many, some, any

Numerals

one, two, three, twenty, forty

Ordinals

first, second, 1st, 2nd, 3rd, next, last

Type of determiner depends on the type of noun — Singular Nouns always need a determiner, Plural Nouns: determiner optional, Uncountable Nouns: determiner also optional.



Some / Any and Each / Every

SOME & ANY

- **Some** is used in affirmative sentences. *I have some pencils.*
- **Some** is used in interrogative sentences when the answer is expected to be "yes", or when the sentence is a request or an invitation.
- **Any** is used in negative and interrogative sentences. *I haven't any money.*
- **Any** is used in interrogative sentences when we are not sure of the answer: *Have you any books?*

EACH & EVERY

- **Each** can be used for two or more persons/things while **every** is not normally used for very small numbers.

Two boys came. Each boy carried books.

Every boy in our class has done his work.



SECTION B · DETERMINERS

Few, A Few, The Few & Little, A Little, The Little

Determiner	Meaning	Example
<u>Few</u>	not many, hardly any (negative)	It is sad that he has <u>few</u> friends.
<u>A few</u>	some, a small number (positive)	It is good that he has at least <u>a few</u> friends.
<u>The few</u>	not many, but all of them (specific)	He has lost <u>the few</u> friends he had.
<u>Little</u>	hardly any (negative, uncountable)	He cannot lend you anything because he has <u>little</u> money.
<u>A little</u>	some but not much (positive, uncountable)	Please do forgive me <u>a little</u> time to prepare tea.
<u>The little</u>	not much, but all of it (specific)	The cat drank away <u>the little</u> milk that was in the pot.



SECTION C · ARTICLES

A, An & The — Meet the Articles

A, an and the are called Articles. They are a special sub-group of determiners that show whether we mean something specific or something general.

INDEFINITE ARTICLES

A and An

Used to modify non-specific or non-particular nouns — any one of a class/group. Used before singular countable nouns only.

DEFINITE ARTICLE

The

Used to refer to a specific or particular noun — a person, place, or thing already known to speaker and listener, or unique in the world.

JUST FOR FUN

"A" and "an" are like saying "some random one" — "the" is like pointing your finger and saying "that exact one!"



Using 'A' and 'An' Correctly

'A' is used:

- Before words beginning with a consonant **SOUND**: *a boy, a bird*
- Before a singular noun beginning with a consonant **letter**: *a book, a school, a dog*
- Even before vowel **LETTERS** that don't have a vowel sound: *a European, a unit, a union*

Handwritten notes for 'A' usage:
- A circle around the letter 'y' with a line pointing to the word 'European' in the list.
- A circle around the letter 'i' with a line pointing to the word 'unit' in the list.

'An' is used:

- Before a word beginning with a vowel **SOUND** (a, e, i, o, u): *an idiot, an apple, an orange, an umbrella, an eye*
- Before a word beginning with silent 'h': *an honour, an hour, an honest man*
- Some words start with a vowel **LETTER** but a consonant **SOUND** — use "a" for these: *a university, a uniform, a one-rupee note*

Handwritten notes for 'An' usage:
- Underlines under the words 'honour', 'hour', and 'honest' in the third bullet point.
- A circle around the word 'university' in the fourth bullet point.
- A circle around the word 'uniform' in the fourth bullet point.
- A circle around the word 'one-rupee' in the fourth bullet point.
- A handwritten 'd' with a line pointing to the word 'one-rupee'.

A

SECTION C • ARTICLES

'The' Article — In Full Detail (Part 1)

The is called the DEFINITE article because it refers to a particular, already-known person, place, or thing. Here are the key situations where we must use "the":

1

Unique Objects

Only one of its kind in the world.

the sky, the sun, the moon, the world, the North Pole

2

Superlative Degree

Before the highest form of an adjective.

the best, the tallest, the most beautiful

3

Rivers, Mountains, Oceans & Deserts

Names of geographical features (not individual mountain peaks).

the Ganges, the Himalayas, the Pacific, the Sahara

4

Names of Books / Scriptures

Well-known books, holy scriptures, and newspapers.

the Bible, the Ramayana, the Quran, the Times of India

5

Musical Instruments

Before the names of instruments a person plays.

the flute, the violin, the guitar



'The' Article — In Full Detail (Part 2)

6

Adjective Denoting a Whole Class

The + adjective = all people of that kind.

the rich, the poor, the old, the blind

7

Before Ordinals

first, second, third, etc.

the first, the ninth, the last chapter

8

Proper Names of Peoples / Nations (plural)

Nationalities used as plural nouns.

the French, the Indians, the Americans

9

Well-Known Abbreviations

Acronyms of organisations/countries.

the UN, the USA, the IMF

10

Decades, Special Dates, Time Phrases with of

Groups of years, or "of" phrases.

the 1990s, the 4th of July, the Middle Ages

💡 JUST FOR FUN

Watch out: we say "Mount Everest" and "Lake Victoria" — NO "the" before a single named mountain or lake!



When We DROP the Article Altogether

Sometimes no article is used at all — this is called the omission of the article:

Before names of relations (father, uncle, sister)

Before proper nouns (Lotus, Chennai, Priya)

Before language names (Tamil, Hindi, English)

Before names of material (gold, silver, diamond)

Before abstract nouns (honesty, wisdom, truth)

Before certain phrases (at noon, by train, on foot)

Quick Fill-in Practice

 Ganges is holy water. → The Ganges is holy water.
He worked efficiently as M.L.A. → He worked efficiently as an M.L.A.
Heaven is happiest place. → Heaven is the happiest place.



Finite vs Non-Finite Verbs

FINITE VERB

A finite verb is a verb that has a SUBJECT and shows TENSE.

John cooks carrots.

The finite verb is "cooks." The subject is "John." The tense of the verb is the present tense.

NON-FINITE VERB

A Non-Finite verb is derived from a verb but has NO SUBJECT, and therefore is not limited by the number and person of any noun or pronoun.

He They like to play football.

The verb "play" has no subject, isn't limited by number/person, and isn't limited by tense.

The 3 Types of Non-Finite Verbs

INFINITIVE (to + verb — acts as noun/adjective/adverb)

GERUND (verb + -ing — acts as a noun)

PARTICIPLE (acts as an adjective)



The Infinitive — "to + Verb"

An infinitive is a Non-Finite Verb that is generally preceded by "to", and is used like a noun, adjective, or adverb.

The students like TO JOIN our club.

It is easy TO CRITICIZE others.

The captain hopes TO WIN the game.

The girl is too sick TO WALK.

The children have come TO SEE the dance performance.



Infinitive WITHOUT "to"

1

After do, did, we, shall, can, etc.

She can sing. (She knows how to sing.)
You shall go with me. (Forced to go with)

2

After certain verbs: bid, feel, hear, know, watch, notice, etc.

I heard her sing.
Bid him go there.

3

"To" is omitted after "than" and "but" (when but means "except")

The students would rather play than study.
He did nothing but complain.



The Participle — Present & Past

A Participle is a Non-Finite Verb that does the work of an ADJECTIVE.

PRESENT PARTICIPLE

Gerund

- Ends "-ing"
- Is formed from a verb
- Used as an adjective or for verb tense

The fleeing criminal (adjective, from "to flee")

He was waving his cutlass. (verb tense, from "to wave")

adv

PAST PARTICIPLE

Participle

- Formed from a verb
- Used as an adjective or for verb tense
- Ends "-ed, -d, -t" (or irregular form)

his painted skin (adjective, from "to paint")

I have forgotten my lines. (verb tense, from "to forget")



S V A

The Gerund — and How It Differs from a Participle

A word that acts like a verb but performs the work of a NOUN is called a Gerund. It always ends in "-ing".

Swimming is good for health.

Collecting stamps is her hobby.

Participle	Gerund	Infinitive
Acts as an <u>ADJECTIVE</u> e.g. the drunken man, a ruined city, a misspelled word	Acts as a NOUN e.g. Seeing is <u>believing</u> . I enjoy studying coins.	Also acts as a NOUN e.g. To play is the only thing Pari wants to do once she finishes her exams.

Gerund vs Present Participle — both end in "-ing", but:

A Gerund is a Verbal NOUN: Grumbling people are not liked.

A Present Participle is a Verbal ADJECTIVE: I am tired of your grumbling.



Master Table — All 4 Topics at a Glance

Modal	Key Use	Article	Used For	Determiner	Use	Non-Finite	Form
Can / Could	Ability, permission, request	A / An	One of a class (indefinite)	Some	Affirmative / offers	Infinitive	to + verb (noun/adj/adv)
May / Might	Permission, possibility	The	Specific / unique thing	Any	Negative / questions	Gerund	verb + ing (noun)
Must	Obligation, strong conclusion	(no article)	Relations, materials, proper nouns, languages	Each / Every	2+ / larger groups	Present Participle	verb + ing (adjective)
Should / Ought to	Advice, correctness	The + superlative	the best, the tallest	Few / A few	Negative / positive (countable)	Past Participle	verb + ed/d/t (adjective)
Will / Would	Decision, offer, promise	The + rivers/mountains	the Ganges, the Alps	Little / A little	Negative / positive (uncountable)		
Shall	Offer, suggestion						

Finite verb = has subject + tense. Non-finite verb = no subject, not limited by number/person/tense.



Set 1 — Modal Verbs

Q1. [8th SB • 2 Marks]

Fill in the blank with a suitable modal: "You ___ finish your homework before playing." (obligation)

must

Q2. [8th CBSE • 2 Marks]

Choose the correct modal: "___ I open the window, please?" (asking permission)

May



Set 2 — Determiners

Q3. [9th CBSE • 2 Marks]

Fill in the blank with "some" or "any": "Is there ___ milk left in the fridge?"

Some

Q4. [10th SB • 2 Marks]

Fill in with "few / a few / the few": "She has ___ friends left after moving to a new city, but they are loyal."

a few



Set 3 — Articles

Q5. [8th SB • 3 Marks]

Fill in the blanks with a, an, or the: "~~the~~ Himalayas stand as a sentinel to our country."

The

Q6. [9th CBSE • 3 Marks]

Fill in the blanks: "He worked efficiently as an M.L.A., and everyone respected him as an honest man."

an an



Set 4 — Non-Finite Verbs

Q7. [10th SB • 3 Marks]

gerund

Identify the non-finite verb and its type: "Swimming in the lake is her favourite pastime."

Q8. [8th CBSE • 3 Marks]

Complete using an infinitive: "The children were too tired to (play) any further."



LET'S RECAP

Key Takeaways from Today

Modals

No -s, no auxiliary needed for negatives/questions, always followed by the base verb.

Determiners

Some/any, each/every, few/a few/the few, little/a little/the little — each has a precise shade of meaning.

Articles

A/an for one of a class; the for something specific, unique, or already known — remember all 10 uses of 'the'.

Non-Finite Verbs

Infinitives (to+verb), Gerunds (verb+ing as noun), Participles (verb+ing/ed as adjective) — none show tense or take a subject.



Great Work, Everyone!

Practice 5 sentences each with modals, determiners, articles & non-finite verbs before our next session.